

News

Forum on microaggressions in the workplace Jan. 20

Friday, January 15, 2021



The WaTech Inclusion, Respect, Equity, Diversity (WIRED) team will be hosting its first quarterly forum on Microaggressions in the Workplace from 2-3 p.m. on Wed., Jan. 20.

Ayanna Colman, the Employment Security Department's Director of Equity, Diversity, and Inclusion, will give the presentation.

"The intent of this forum is to help employees identify what microaggressions may look like," says WaTech Deputy

Director of Administrative Services Wendi Gunther. "Our intention is to show how and why they happen, how this behavior affects people in the workplace, and offer ways to prevent and address microaggressions in a positive manner when they do occur."

The challenge of identifying and addressing microaggression is because they are often subtle, usually unintentional and ambiguous. "The behavior may be committed by people who don't even realize when they are doing it," said Gunther. "Offering forums like this gives our employees a chance to become more self-aware in their interactions with others and helps us all treat each other with respect."

Employees will have an opportunity for discussion and ask questions during the forum, and additional materials will be made available to anyone who wants them.

"We will also be seeking feedback from you on what you would like to see in these forums as we move forward on our EDI journey," said Gunther.

WIRED was formed to create awareness, educate and advance the values that promote a more equitable, inclusive and respectful workplace that makes all employees feel safe and heard. The workgroup, which was created last year, recently completed drafting several policies related to Diversity, Equity and Inclusion; Respectful Work Environment; Anti-Discrimination, Harassment and Sexual Harassment; and Reasonable Accommodation.

[Contact Wendi Gunther to learn more about WIRED.](#)

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